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7CS076 Project Management 2.4

Critical Reading - Evaluation of Sources

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Learning Outcomes

- By the end of this session, you will be able to:
  - Identify the need to read critically
  - Be aware of how to analyse and evaluate text you read.

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Critical Reading

- Critical reading involves making judgements about the text
- Do not read looking only for information
- Criticism involves analysing and evaluating
- Criticism does not mean rubbishing - criticism can be positive as well as negative
- Whether positive or negative you must be able to articulate your judgement.

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Critical Reading

- Central to critical reading
- Arguments
- An argument has at least two components:-
  - The making of a point
  - Providing reason.

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Analyse the Text

- Identify main points, purpose and the intended audience
- Evidence to support the main point
- Evidence to support subsidiary points
- Underlying or apparent assumptions or biases
- How is text organised to support argument?
- What is the source of the evidence? Is it primary or secondary & what methods has the author used to gather primary evidence?

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Evaluate the Text

- Evaluate facts for accuracy - terms clearly defined
- Text well-organised, clear and easy to read, appropriate for the intended audience - Argument logical
- Sufficient evidence in arguments to support main point
- Strengths/Weaknesses - address opposing or alternative points of view
- Text fit in with other knowledge / information on the topic of the project
- Questions or observations raised by the text

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Summary

- Evaluate as you read – critical reading

From last week's lecture;

- Evaluation of Academic Quality of Sources
  - Popular or Scholarly Resources
  - CARS – evaluation checklist
  - Internet Sources – further evaluation checklist
- Several YouTube videos on Evaluating Websites/Sources
  - Some examples below;

http://www.youtube.com/watch?NR=1&v=ZMb0_5pI-u4

http://www.youtube.com/watch?v=J_qR5lpnXBE&feature=related

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Look Forward

- Next week we discuss:
  - Estimation Methods, Estimating Time and Quality, Project Appraisal, Project Evaluation and Business Measures
- Read the supporting library documents
  - LS118-Introduction-to-critical-reading
  - LS119-Introduction-to-critical-writing